Isabella Melendez Gonzalez

Product Designer

Austin, TX | (346) 600-3380 | isabella.mel.gon@gmail.com | isamelendez.com | linkedin.com/in/isabella-mel-gon

SUMMARY

Product Designer and Informatics student at UT Austin who approaches every decision with intention, prioritizing real user needs over assumptions. With a strong focus on accessibility and inclusion, I leverage my experience in cross-functional collaboration to translate research insights into thoughtful, effective design solutions.

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Austin Expected May 2028

Bachelor of Science in Informatics, User Experience Design | GPA: 4.00

Honors: School of Information Distinguished College Scholar (2026); Dean's List (Fall 2024, Spring 2025)

EXPERIENCE

Design Director | Texas Product Engineering Organization (TPEO) April 2026 – Present

- Lead the Design Core of 4 design leads and a 9 week product design curriculum updated for emerging tools like AI
- Teach weekly design workshops for 5 student designers and provide 1:1 support outside of sessions
- Partner with product and engineering leadership to align curriculum and workshops across teams

Marketing Director | Texas Product Engineering Organization (TPEO) May 2025 – April 2026

- Designed Instagram posts and recruitment flyers reaching 1,000–5,000 views per post

UX/UI Designer | Longhorn Developers (LHD); UT Parking and Transportation Services May 2025 – Present

- Redesign ride requests for Sure Walk, a student rideshare service handling 200–300+ requests a day, replacing a repetitive Google Form with an intuitive mobile app
- Conduct 30+ user interviews with students and staff, synthesizing findings through affinity mapping in FigJam into journey maps and feature requirements
- Wireframe sign-up and ride request flows, refining them through repeated usability tests with 3 users
- Co-create the app's design system of custom components and typography, built on UT brand colors
- Translate technical requirements into designs in weekly meetings with product managers and engineers

Design & Web Development Student Technology Assistant | LAITS, UT Austin March 2026 – Present

- Develop a consistent visual brand for LAITS and apply it across posters, graphics, and department materials
- Design visual assets for faculty, clarifying instructional materials used across 1,000+ classrooms
- Maintain instructional web content, ensuring accessibility and brand consistency across department sites

Product Design Volunteer | Texas Cultural Trust Sept 2025 – May 2026

- Created the information architecture, wireframes, and interactive prototypes for a public-facing Events webpage concept, making arts events across Texas easier to discover while reducing information overload
- Presented design decisions in weekly reviews with 3 stakeholders, explaining UX choices in plain language to align user needs with organizational goals
- Scoped requirements and set design direction independently, grounding decisions in secondary research when direct user interviews weren't possible

SKILLS

Research: User Interviews, Usability Testing, Affinity Mapping, Journey Mapping, Secondary Research

Design: Wireframing, Prototyping, Information Architecture, Visual Design, Accessibility and Inclusive Design

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Adobe Illustrator and Adobe Photoshop (certified)